

To enter in single user mode, restart the system, and select your Linux OS (do not press 'Enter' on it). Now, press 'e' on the kernel line to edit the kernel parameters. Add 'S' as the kernel parameter (do not add quotes). Press Enter to escape from editing; now, press 'b' to boot.

You will be on the root shell. Now, it's time to change the password.

```
#passwd
```

You will now be asked for the new password.

If you have forgotten the grub password, then use any Linux live CD, like Ubuntu. Go to the specific drive that has your Linux/boot and edit grub.conf and comment out the password line to remove the password.

SSH from behind HTTP proxy

Ever wanted to establish an SSH connection from behind your college/office proxy? You can do that with a nifty program called Corkscrew. Corkscrew allows tunnelling SSH through HTTP proxies. Get the tarball from <http://www.agroman.net/corkscrew/>. After the usual extract, configure, make, make install sequence, add the following line to your ~/.ssh/config file:

```
ProxyCommand/usr/local/bin/corkscrew "Proxy_Server" "Proxy_  
Port" %h %p
```

And that's it. You should now be able to ssh to any external computer.

—Anmol Sarma, unmole.in@gmail.com

List overall RPM with sorted size

The following command will display the list of the overall RPMs installed in Red Hat Linux with size in sorted order:

```
$ rpm -qa --qf '%11{SIZE} %{NAME}\n' | sort -k1n
```

—Ajeet Singh Raina, ajeetraina@gmail.com

Know who did what

accton and lastcomm—accounting on and last commands—can enable you to monitor users on your system. As the root, you would implement this as follows.

Note: The default file location is /var/account/pacct. So we'll turn it on, system-wide, with the following command:

```
# accton /var/account/pacct
```

Now, take a look at this file. It will grow. To see the

commands that are executed, use the lastcomm command.

```
# lastcomm
```

The above command gives an output for all users. To get the data for user 'john', execute the following command:

```
# lastcomm --user john
```

You can also get a summary of commands with sa:

```
# sa  
30 5.23re 0.00cp 10185k  
11 4.83re 0.00cp 8961k ***other  
8 0.13re 0.00cp 19744k bash  
4 0.00re 0.00cp 2542k ssh  
3 0.00re 0.00cp 680k su  
2 0.13re 0.00cp 17424k check_ping  
2 0.13re 0.00cp 978k ping
```

To turn off accounting, execute accton without a filename:

```
# accton
```

—Selvaraj, selvaraj2005@gmail.com

How to find the virtual memory PAGESIZE in Ubuntu?

A page is a fixed length block of main memory, which is contiguous in both physical memory addressing and virtual memory addressing.

The kernel swaps and allocates memory using pages. The command to know the PAGESIZE is:

```
$ getconf PAGESIZE
```

The result will be as follows:

```
verman@verman-desktop:~/$ getconf PAGE_SIZE  
4096
```

—Srinivasaverman, msverman@gmail.com

END

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The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in LFY so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at www.linuxforu.com. The sender of each published tip will get an LFY T-shirt.